

MOVIE

Sonic the Hedgehog

★★★★☆ | When the trailer for Sonic the Hedgehog first dropped last year, there were a lot of things going through people's minds. The first, of course, was that heinous character design. What was that?! That was some kind of monstrosity. Then, of course, there's the taboo associated with video game movies in general. Historically, they don't tend to do too well in the box office.

Thankfully, they actually went back to the drawing board after hearing the fan's outcry and fixed Sonic! They actually fixed him and he looked a lot more like his original self in the new trailers. Now all that was left was the movie itself. Well, we're glad to report that the movie was actually pretty



good. Easily one of the best video game movies to-date. For that matter, it has actually surpassed Detective Pikachu as the highest grossing video-game movie in the US. Well deserved, if you ask us. The film had a lot going for it and time flew while watching it.

Firstly, the movie manages to capture the essence of Sonic really well, and Jim Carrey as Eggman was a match made in heaven. James Marsden as Thomas "Tom" Wachowski, the sheriff of Green Hills is quite endearing too. Him and Sonic had a couple of heartwarming moments too. There are plenty of action sequences and moments, some special effects here and there to show off that high-speed action, and lots of laughs.

The ending of the movie definitely points towards a possible sequel(s). It also introduces another famous character from the Sonic universe. Long time fans of Sonic will probably get it in the first guess.

While this movie was all about Sonic's iconic rings, there was absolutely no mention of the chaos emeralds, another thing long time fans will be familiar with, but we're guessing they'll get to those in the sequel. Overall, Sonic the Hedgehog was a fun ride from start to finish and we're looking forward to the sequel.

TV SHOW

Kingdom (Season 2)

★★★★☆ | Netflix's Kingdom Season 2 bursts ahead with the same tempo as the previous season. The story continues right from where Season 1 ended with the Crown prince attempting to hold off a swarm of zombies that have taken over the countryside like a plague.

They are soon to be made aware of their underpreparedness due to a change in dynamic of the zombie behaviour. This new mechanic is seamlessly stitched into the zombie mechanic with some careful retconning and thus, a change in strategy is urgently required.

While the zombie menace is certainly the larger concern, the political machinations of the Cho Hak-Ju clan



are also at play giving the series a layered storyline and narrative that keeps viewers fixated to their screens. Allies turn into foes and foes turn into allies throughout the series.

Every episode in the series seems to hold the tempo consistently with

each episode ending in a cliffhanger making the previous one jump right into the next episode.

By keeping the series limited to six episodes, the makers have managed to sustain the horror and thrill without having to stretch plotlines just for the sake of it. This consistency is what we believe makes the Kingdom worthy of your time.

However, distilling the storyline to produce dense episodes would also imply that there would be less scope for another season to follow the second season. Nevertheless, we'd like to turn your attention back to the retconning mechanism that the showrunners used to begin Season 2 with. We wouldn't be surprised if they managed to slip in another twist and extract another season or two from the storyline.

All we can say for certain is that if the third season turns out to be anywhere similar to the first two seasons, then we're certainly going to be first in line to watch it.